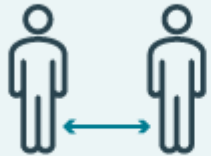




COVID-19



WEAR A MASK



STAY 6 FEET APART



AVOID CROWDS



GET A VACCINE

Self-Testing

Updated Apr. 15, 2021



If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you and your healthcare provider can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home-test" or an "at-home test."

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter in a pharmacy or retail store without a prescription. Currently available self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an [anterior nasal swab](#) or a [nasal mid-turbinate swab](#).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or discolored.
- Disinfect the countertop, table, or other surface where you will do the test.
- Don't open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, disinfect all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Communicate your results to your healthcare provider, who is responsible for reporting your test results to the state health department. If the at-home test has an app that allows you to report your results to the state health department, inform your healthcare provider whether you used that app for results reporting.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result usually means your current illness is not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19 (this is called a false negative). You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness. Discuss your symptoms and test results with your healthcare provider to determine if you need follow-up testing.

If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell your healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC’s guidance [Isolate if You are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn’t have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home, wear a mask. Don’t share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your close contacts that they may have been exposed to COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are not clear or are inconclusive, and the test is unable to tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with your healthcare provider. Your healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

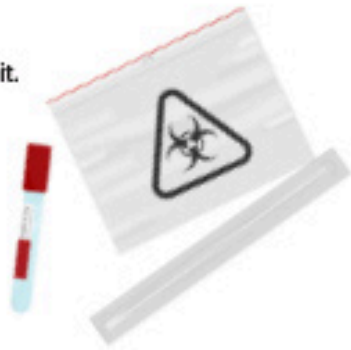
Print Resources



Follow the instructions included with your sample kit. Use **only** materials provided in your kit to collect and store your sample, unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use **only** an approved sampling kit given to you by your healthcare provider or by personnel at the testing center.

Initial set-up

1. Open the sampling kit.



2. Apply hand sanitizer with at least 60% alcohol.

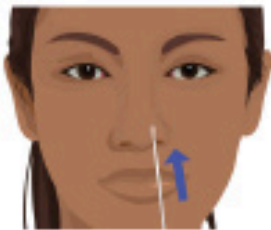


Sample collection

3. Remove the swab from the container, being careful not to touch the soft end with your hand.



4. Insert the swab into your nostril. Do not insert it more than half an inch into your nostril.



5. Slowly twist the swab, rubbing it along the insides of your nostril for 15 seconds.



How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [402 KB, 2 pages]
Español [454 KB, 2 pages]

HOW TO COLLECT A NASAL MID-TURBINATE SPECIMEN FOR COVID-19 TESTING



Use only an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use only materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril less than one inch (about 2cm) or until resistance is felt.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4-6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Sample for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MEI, 2 pages]

Español [4 MEI, 2 pages]

Last Updated Apr. 15, 2021



COVID-19

Get Vaccinated: [Find a vaccine](#) and learn what you can do after you're [fully vaccinated](#).

Self-Testing

Updated Apr. 25, 2021



If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you and your healthcare provider can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home-test" or an "at-home test."

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter in a pharmacy or retail store without a prescription. Currently available self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an [anterior nasal swab](#) or a [nasal mid-turbinate swab](#).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or discolored.
- Disinfect the countertop, table, or other surface where you will do the test.
- Don't open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, disinfect all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Communicate your results to your healthcare provider, who is responsible for reporting your test results to the state health department. If the at-home test has an app that allows you to report your results to the state health department, inform your healthcare provider whether you used that app for results reporting.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result usually means your current illness is not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19 (this is called a false negative). You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness. Discuss your symptoms and test results with your healthcare provider to determine if you need follow-up testing.

If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell your healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate if You are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are not clear or are inconclusive, and the test is unable to tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with your healthcare provider. Your healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

CS11792-C 04/13/2021

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [372 KB, 2 pages]

Español [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



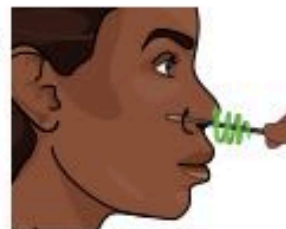
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Last Updated Apr. 25, 2021



COVID-19

IF YOU ARE FULLY VACCINATED

Find [new guidance for fully vaccinated people](#). If you are not vaccinated, [find a vaccine](#).

Self-Testing

Updated May 14, 2021

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by an individual at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- If an individual tests positive, they should isolate and inform any close contacts.

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms associated with COVID-19 you should [quarantine](#) and be tested. If you are unvaccinated and think you were exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should be tested. Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home test" or an "at-home test."

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter, without a prescription, in a pharmacy or retail store. Currently available self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Read the complete set of the manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an [anterior nasal swab](#) or a [nasal mid-turbinate swab](#).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or discolored.
- Disinfect the countertop, table, or other surface where you will do the test.
- Don't open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, disinfect all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate if You are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are not clear or are inconclusive, and the test is unable to tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

Print Resources

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

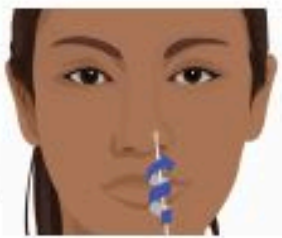
3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



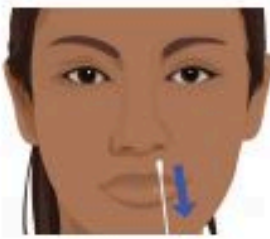
4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

CS317702-C 04/13/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [372 KB, 2 pages]
Español  [395 KB, 2 pages]

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How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



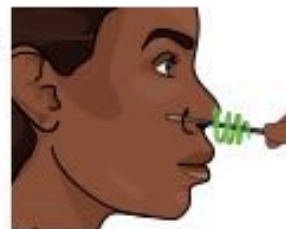
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Last Updated May 14, 2021



COVID-19

IF YOU ARE FULLY VACCINATED

Find [new guidance for fully vaccinated people](#). If you are not vaccinated, [find a vaccine](#).

Self-Testing

Updated June 11, 2021

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by an individual at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- If an individual tests positive, they should isolate and inform any close contacts.

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms associated with COVID-19 you should [quarantine](#) and be tested. If you are unvaccinated and think you were exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should be tested. Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

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Read the complete set of the manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options. The tool helps individuals determine what type of test they should seek. After test results are in, the tool can help interpret test results and guide next steps.

Get Started

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an [anterior nasal swab](#) or a [nasal mid-turbinate swab](#).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or discolored.
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- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

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Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate if You are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer’s instructions for serial testing. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are not clear or are inconclusive, and the test is unable to tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

Print Resources

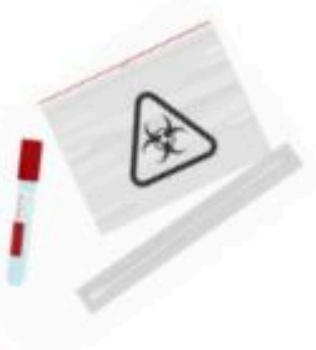
How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

cdc.gov/coronavirus

CS311702-C 04/13/2021

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [372 KB, 2 pages]
Español  [395 KB, 2 pages]

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How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



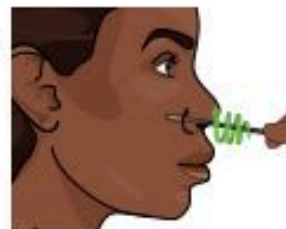
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Last Updated June 11, 2021



COVID-19

UPDATE

Getting vaccinated prevents severe illness, hospitalizations, and death. Unvaccinated people should get vaccinated and continue masking until they are fully vaccinated. With the Delta variant, this is more urgent than ever. CDC has updated [guidance for fully vaccinated people](#) based on new evidence on the Delta variant.

Self-Testing

Updated July 21, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of July 21, 2021



- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by a person at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- Self-tests can be used by anyone who is symptomatic regardless of their vaccination status.
- Unvaccinated persons with no COVID-19 symptoms can also use self-tests, especially if they were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19.
- [If an individual tests positive](#), they should isolate and inform any close contacts.

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms associated with COVID-19, you should [quarantine](#) and be tested regardless of your vaccination status. If you are unvaccinated and think you were exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should be tested. Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home test" or an "at-home test." [FDA](#)  provides information on which self-tests are authorized for use.

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter, without a prescription, in a pharmacy or retail store. At present, self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options. The tool helps individuals determine what type of test they should seek. After test results are in, the tool can help interpret test results and guide next steps.

[Get Started](#)

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an anterior nasal swab or a nasal mid-turbinate swab (see the [Print Resources](#) section below).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer's instructions.
- Clean the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Don't open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, clean all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate If You Are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing that are included within the kit during purchase, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#)  or [antigen](#) ) on the FDA website. They will likely recommend you to test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are inconclusive or not clear, and the test cannot tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

CS-311762-C 04/13/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [372 KB, 2 pages]

Español [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



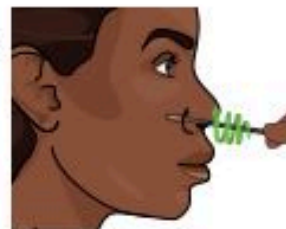
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Last Updated July 21, 2021



COVID-19

To maximize protection from the [Delta variant](#) and prevent possibly spreading it to others, wear a mask indoors in public if you are in an [area of substantial or high transmission](#).

Self-Testing

Updated Aug. 2, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of August 2, 2021



- Added a recommendation for fully vaccinated people who have a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 to be tested 3-5 days after exposure, and to wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
- Added language about quarantining for fully vaccinated and unvaccinated people.

[View Previous Updates](#)

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by a person at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- Self-tests can be used by anyone who is symptomatic regardless of their vaccination status.
- Unvaccinated persons with no COVID-19 symptoms can also use self-tests, especially if they were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19.
- [If an individual tests positive](#), they should isolate and inform any close contacts.

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms or have had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested regardless of your vaccination status. Quarantine if you have been in close contact (within 6 feet of someone for a cumulative total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone who has COVID-19, unless you have been fully vaccinated.

People who are fully vaccinated do NOT need to quarantine after contact with someone who had COVID-19 unless they have symptoms. Although the risk that fully vaccinated people could become infected with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19 is low, any fully vaccinated person who experiences symptoms consistent with COVID-19 should isolate themselves from others, be clinically evaluated for COVID-19, and tested for SARS-CoV-2 if indicated. Get tested 3-5 days following a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 and wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days after exposure or until a negative test result.

Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home test" or an "at-home test." [FDA](#)  provides information on which self-tests are authorized for use.

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter, without a prescription, in a pharmacy or retail store. At present, self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an anterior nasal swab or a nasal mid-turbinate swab (see the [Print Resources](#) section below).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer's instructions.
- Clean the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Don't open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, clean all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate If You Are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing that are included within the kit during purchase, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#)  or [antigen](#) ) on the FDA website. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are inconclusive or not clear, and the test cannot tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



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Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

CS11792-C 04/13/2021

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [372 KB, 2 pages]

Español [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



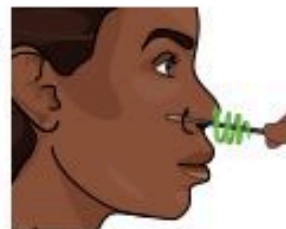
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content



As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Last Updated Aug. 2, 2021



COVID-19

To maximize protection from the [Delta variant](#) and prevent possibly spreading it to others, get vaccinated as soon as you can and wear a mask indoors in public if you are in [an area of substantial or high transmission](#).

Self-Testing

Updated Sept. 28, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of August 2, 2021



- Added a recommendation for fully vaccinated people who have a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 to be tested 3-5 days after exposure, and to wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
- Added language about quarantining for fully vaccinated and unvaccinated people.

[View Previous Updates](#)

Key Points

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- [If an individual tests positive](#), they should isolate and inform any close contacts.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

How To Use a Self-Test

How To Interpret Self-Test Results

Overview

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms or have had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested regardless of your vaccination status. Quarantine if you have been in close contact (within 6 feet of someone for a cumulative total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone who has COVID-19, unless you have been fully vaccinated.

People who are fully vaccinated do NOT need to quarantine after contact with someone who had COVID-19 unless they have symptoms. Although the risk that fully vaccinated people could become infected with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19 is low, any fully vaccinated person who experiences symptoms consistent with COVID-19 should isolate themselves from others, be clinically evaluated for COVID-19, and tested for SARS-CoV-2 if indicated. Get tested 3-5 days following a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 and wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days after exposure or until a negative test result.

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- If you don’t collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer’s instructions, to complete the self-test.

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Follow the manufacturer’s instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

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- Check the expiration date. Don’t use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer’s instructions.
- Clean the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Don’t open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer’s instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don’t reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, clean all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate If You Are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing that are included within the kit during purchase, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#) [↗](#) or [antigen](#) [↗](#)) on the FDA website. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are inconclusive or not clear, and the test cannot tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

Print Resources

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

CS31792-C 04/13/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [372 KB, 2 pages]
Español  [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [4 MB, 2 pages]
Español  [4 MB, 2 pages]

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content

As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.

SAppx1539

- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Last Updated Sept. 28, 2021



COVID-19

To maximize protection from the [Delta variant](#) and prevent possibly spreading it to others, get vaccinated as soon as you can and wear a mask indoors in public if you are in [an area of substantial or high transmission](#).

Self-Testing

Updated Oct. 4, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of August 2, 2021



- Added a recommendation for fully vaccinated people who have a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 to be tested 3-5 days after exposure, and to wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
- Added language about quarantining for fully vaccinated and unvaccinated people.

[View Previous Updates](#)

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by a person at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- Self-tests can be used by anyone who is symptomatic regardless of their vaccination status.
- Unvaccinated persons with no COVID-19 symptoms can also use self-tests, especially if they were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19.
- [If an individual tests positive](#), they should isolate and inform any close contacts.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

How To Use a Self-Test

How To Interpret Self-Test Results

Overview

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms or have had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested regardless of your vaccination status. Quarantine if you have been in close contact (within 6 feet of someone for a cumulative total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone who has COVID-19, unless you have been fully vaccinated.

People who are fully vaccinated do NOT need to quarantine after contact with someone who had COVID-19 unless they have symptoms. Although the risk that fully vaccinated people could become infected with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19 is low, any fully vaccinated person who experiences symptoms consistent with COVID-19 should isolate themselves from others, be clinically evaluated for COVID-19, and tested for SARS-CoV-2 if indicated. Get tested 3-5 days following a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 and wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days after exposure or until a negative test result.

Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home test" or an "at-home test." [FDA](#)  provides information on which self-tests are authorized for use.

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter, without a prescription, in a pharmacy or retail store. At present, self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an anterior nasal swab or a nasal mid-turbinate swab (see the [Print Resources](#) section below).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer’s instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don’t collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.



Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer’s instructions, to complete the self-test.

Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer’s instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer’s instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don’t use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer’s instructions.
- Clean the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Don’t open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer’s instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don’t reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, clean all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.



If Your Test Is Positive

Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate If You Are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing that are included within the kit during purchase, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#) [↗](#) or [antigen](#) [↗](#)) on the FDA website. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are inconclusive or not clear, and the test cannot tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

Print Resources

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

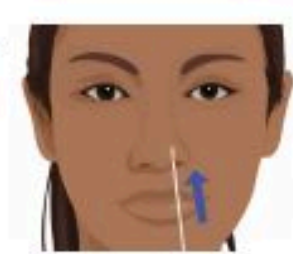
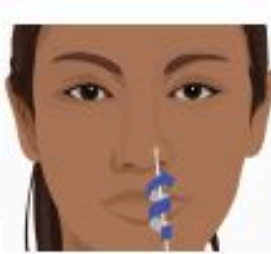
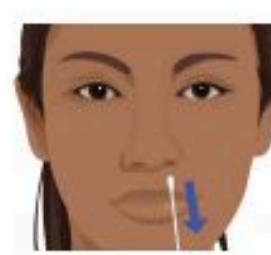


Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.
2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.

Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.
4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than ¾ of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.
6. Gently remove the swab.
7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

CS317702-C 04/13/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [372 KB, 2 pages]

Español  [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



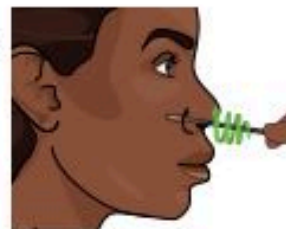
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content



As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Last Updated Oct. 4, 2021



COVID-19

Self-Testing

Updated Oct. 21, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of October 21, 2021



- Based on evolving evidence, CDC recommends fully vaccinated people get tested 5-7 days after close contact with a person with suspected or confirmed COVID-19.

[View Previous Updates](#)

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by a person at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- Self-tests can be used by anyone who is symptomatic regardless of their vaccination status.
- Unvaccinated persons with no COVID-19 symptoms can also use self-tests, especially if they were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19.
- [If an individual tests positive](#), they should isolate and inform any close contacts.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

Video Resources

How To Use a Self-Test

How To Interpret Self-Test Results

Overview

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms or have had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested regardless of your vaccination status. Quarantine if you have been in close contact (within 6 feet of someone for a cumulative total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone who has COVID-19, unless you have been fully vaccinated.

People who are fully vaccinated do NOT need to quarantine after contact with someone who had COVID-19 unless they have symptoms. Although the risk that fully vaccinated people could become infected with SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19 is low, any fully vaccinated person who experiences symptoms consistent with COVID-19 should isolate themselves from others, be clinically evaluated for COVID-19, and tested for SARS-CoV-2 if indicated.

People who have come into [close contact](#) with someone with COVID-19 should be tested to check for infection:

- [Fully vaccinated](#) people should be tested 5–7 days after their last exposure.
- People who are not fully vaccinated should get tested immediately when they find out they are a close contact. If their test result is negative, they should get tested again 5–7 days after their last exposure or immediately if symptoms develop.

Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19 and can't get tested by a healthcare provider, you can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a "home test" or an "at-home test." [FDA](#) [link](#) provides information on which self-tests are authorized for use.

These self-collection kits and tests are available either by prescription or over the counter, without a prescription, in a pharmacy or retail store. At present, self-collection kits and tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an anterior nasal swab or a nasal mid-turbinate swab (see the [Print Resources](#) section below).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap.
- Open the box and follow the manufacturer's instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.

Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer's instructions, to complete the self-test.



Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer's instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don't use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer's instructions.
- Clean the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Don't open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, clean all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.



Reporting Results

Give your results to your healthcare provider or, if you do not have a healthcare provider, to your local or state health department. Some self-tests have an app that will automatically report your results to the appropriate public health authorities.

If Your Test Is Positive



Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC's guidance [Isolate If You Are Sick](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn't have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don't share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19. An infected person can spread COVID-19 starting 48 (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By letting your close contacts know they may have been exposed to COVID-19, you are helping to protect everyone.

If Your Test Is Negative

A negative test result means that SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19, was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing that are included within the kit during purchase, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#) [↗](#) or [antigen](#) [↗](#)) on the FDA website. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes the results are inconclusive or not clear, and the test cannot tell you if your results are positive or negative.

If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of what your test results are, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

Print Resources

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

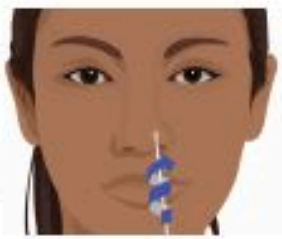
3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



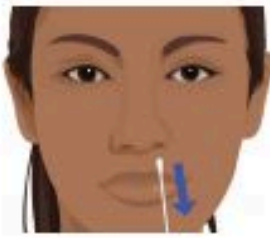
4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

CS 317702-C 04/13/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English  [372 KB, 2 pages]
Español  [395 KB, 2 pages]

SAppx1551

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



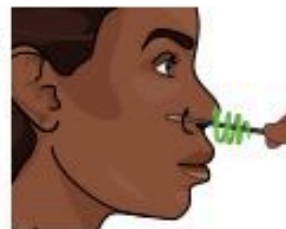
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content

As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Last Updated Oct. 21, 2021



COVID-19

Self-Testing

Updated Nov. 4, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of November 4, 2021



- Self-testing videos are now available to assist with how to use and interpret self-tests.
- Removed recommendation to report test results to healthcare providers or health departments.
- Added guidance about seeking assistance from a healthcare provider if the test result seems incorrect.

Key Points

- Self-tests are performed by a person at home or anywhere.
- All instructions for performing the test must be followed.
- Self-tests can be used by anyone who is symptomatic regardless of their vaccination status.
- Unvaccinated people without COVID-19 symptoms can also use self-tests, especially if they were potentially exposed to someone with COVID-19.
- [If a person tests positive](#), they should isolate and inform any close contacts.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

[Get Started](#)

[About the Tool](#)

Video Resources

How To Use a Self Test

Overview

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of COVID-19. If you have symptoms or have had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested regardless of your vaccination status. If you have recovered from COVID-19 within the past 90 days, you should consult with a healthcare provider regarding being tested again for new or worsening symptoms. Quarantine if you have been in close contact (within 6 feet of someone for a cumulative total of 15 minutes or more over a 24-hour period) with someone who has COVID-19 unless you have been fully vaccinated.

People who are fully vaccinated do not need to quarantine after contact with someone who had COVID-19 unless they have or develop symptoms. A fully vaccinated asymptomatic person should get tested 5–7 days following a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 and wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days after exposure or until receiving a negative test result within that window. Although only a small proportion of fully vaccinated people become infected with COVID-19, any fully vaccinated person who experiences symptoms consistent with COVID-19 should isolate themselves from others, be clinically evaluated for COVID-19, and test for the virus that causes COVID-19.

Fully vaccinated individuals should follow [CDC's recommendations](#) for testing.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19, you can consider using either a **self-collection kit** or a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a “home test” or an “at-home test.” [FDA](#)  provides information on which self-tests are authorized for use.

These self-collection kits and tests are available in pharmacies and retail stores. Some self-collection kits and self-tests require a prescription. At present, self-collection kits and self-tests are used for the detection of [current infection](#).

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results.

Types of Specimens

- Some tests require a **nasal specimen** that can be collected using an anterior nasal swab or a nasal mid-turbinate swab (see the [Print Resources](#) section below).
- Other tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap.

- Open the box and follow the manufacturer’s instructions included with the specimen collection or test kit to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don’t collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.

Once collected, send the specimen to a testing facility or use the specimen, as described in the manufacturer’s instructions, to complete the self-test.



Performing the Test

Follow the manufacturer’s instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer’s instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Don’t use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer’s instructions.
- Clean the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Don’t open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Read and record test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer’s instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don’t reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab and test kit in the trash, clean all surfaces that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.

If Your Test Result Is Positive



Tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them during your illness. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#). See CDC’s guidance [Quarantine and Isolation](#), which has information for a person who tests positive and has symptoms, and for a person who doesn’t have symptoms.

As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home or place of residence. If possible, you should use a separate bathroom. If you need to be around other people or animals in or outside of the home or place of residence, wear a mask. Don’t share personal household items, like cups, towels, and utensils. Monitor your symptoms. If you have an emergency warning sign (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately.

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19. A person with COVID-19 can begin spreading it starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By informing your close contacts they may have been exposed, you are helping to protect everyone.

If you think your positive test result may be incorrect, contact a healthcare provider to determine whether or not additional testing is necessary.

If Your Test Result Is Negative

A negative test result means the virus that causes COVID-19 was not found in your specimen. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19 on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-administered tests come with more than one test and instructions for performing serial testing.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for serial testing that are included within the kit during purchase, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#)  or [antigen](#) ) on the FDA website. They will likely recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If you think your negative test result may be incorrect, contact a healthcare provider to determine whether or not additional testing is necessary.

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes test results are inconclusive or not clear on the test device. If the display on the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Invalid results can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the testing instrument may have malfunctioned. Invalid test results are rare but can occur.

Regardless of your test results, you should always review the results with a healthcare provider. The healthcare provider will consider the test result together with your symptoms and possible exposure in deciding how to care for you.

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

CS-311792-C 04/13/2021

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [372 KB, 2 pages]

Español [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



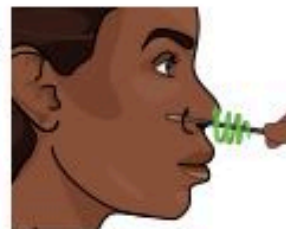
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content

As of October 21, 2021

- Based on evolving evidence, CDC recommends fully vaccinated people get tested 5-7 days after close contact with a person with suspected or confirmed COVID-19.

As of August 2, 2021

- Added a recommendation for fully vaccinated people who have a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 to be tested 3–5 days after exposure, and to wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
- Added language about quarantining for fully vaccinated and unvaccinated people.

As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.

- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Last Updated Nov. 4, 2021



COVID-19

Self-Testing

Updated Dec. 6, 2021

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of December 6, 2021



- Added information on when and why to use a self-test. Self-testing is one of several risk-reduction strategies to reduce the chances of COVID-19 transmission. They may be used regardless of vaccination or symptom status.

[Previous updates](#)

Key Points

- COVID-19 self-tests (also referred to as home tests or over-the-counter (OTC) tests) are one of many risk-reduction measures, along with [vaccination](#), [masking](#), and physical distancing, that [protect you and others](#) by reducing the chances of spreading SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.
- Self-tests can be taken at home or anywhere, are easy to use, and produce rapid results.
- You can use self-tests, regardless of vaccination status, or whether or not you have symptoms.
- Follow all of the manufacturer's instructions for performing the test.
- [If you test positive](#), you should [isolate](#) and inform your healthcare provider, as well as any [close contacts](#).
- Consider using a self-test before joining indoor gatherings with others who are not in your household.
- A positive self-test result means that the test detected the virus, and you are very likely to have an infection and should stay home or isolate for 10 days, wear a mask if you could have contact with others, and avoid indoor gatherings to reduce the risk of spreading disease to someone else.
- A negative self-test result means that the test did not detect the virus and you may not have an infection, but it does not rule out infection. Repeating the test within a few days, with at least 24 hours between tests, will increase the confidence that you are not infected.

Overview

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). Tell your [close contacts](#) that they have been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19.



Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of the virus that causes COVID-19. If you have symptoms or had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested, regardless of your vaccination status. You may also consider self-testing to screen for COVID-19 immediately before an activity to see if you are positive for COVID-19. You should [isolate](#) if you test positive.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19, consider using a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a “home test”, an “at-home test”, or an “over-the-counter (OTC) test.” Visit [FDA's website](#) [↗](#) for a list of authorized tests. Some self-tests may have age limitations.

Self-testing offers fast results. Self-tests are one of several options for testing for the virus that causes COVID-19 and may be more convenient than laboratory-based tests and point-of-care tests. Consider keeping self-tests at home or where you may need them.

Self-tests can also be used as one of many risk-reduction measures, along with vaccination, masking, and physical distancing, that [protect you and others](#) by reducing the chance of viral transmission. You can self-test, even if you don't have symptoms or are fully vaccinated, in order to make decisions that will help prevent spreading COVID-19 to others.

Self-tests can be purchased online or in pharmacies and retail stores. They are also available for free through some [local health departments](#) [↗](#) or Federally Qualified Health Centers (FQHC). As of November 2021, self-tests are available to detect [current infection](#). Self-tests are not available to detect antibodies to the virus that causes COVID-19.

When to Consider Self-Testing

Self-tests may be used if you have COVID-19 symptoms or have been exposed or potentially exposed to an individual with COVID-19.

Even if you don't have symptoms and have not been exposed to an individual with COVID-19, using a self-test before gathering indoors with others can give you information about the risk of spreading the virus that causes COVID-19. This is especially important before gathering with [unvaccinated children](#), [older individuals](#), those who are [immunocompromised](#), or [individuals at risk of severe disease](#).

A positive test result indicates that you likely have a current infection, and you should [isolate](#) and inform [close contacts](#).

A negative test result indicates that you may not be infected and may be at low risk of spreading disease to others, though it does not rule out an infection. Repeating the test will increase the confidence that you are not infected. Performing serial tests, meaning two or more tests over several days with at least 24 hours between tests—with one test as close as possible to the event you will attend—improves the reliability of testing and reduces your risk of transmitting disease to others even further. Some self-tests require this type of repeat testing in the manufacturer's instructions.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

[Get Started](#)[About the Tool](#)

How to Use a Self-Test

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions for use before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results. Refer to CDC's videos on [How to Use a Self-Test](#) and [How to Interpret Self-Test Results](#).

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap and water for at least 20 seconds.
- Open the box and follow the instructions included with the self-test to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.

Perform the Test

Follow the instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Most self-tests require the collection of a **nasal specimen** (see the [Additional Print Resources](#) section below). A few self-tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Once collected, use the specimen as described in the instructions to complete the self-test.

 **Watch Video:** [How to use a self test \[00:01:32\]](#) 

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Do not use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer's instructions.
- [Clean](#) the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Do not open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.
- Have a timer ready because you may need to time several of the test steps.
- Read test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer's instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don't reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab or tube and test in the trash, [clean all surfaces](#) that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.

If Your Test Result Is Positive

You should stay home or isolate for 10 days and wear a mask if others could have contact with you. Also, tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. If you have an [emergency warning sign](#) (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately. To avoid

spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#).

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19. A person with COVID-19 can begin spreading it starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By informing your close contacts they may have been exposed, you are helping to protect everyone.

If you think your positive test result may be incorrect, contact a healthcare provider to determine whether or not additional testing is necessary.

 **Watch Video:** [How to interpret self test results \[00:01:32\]](#) 

If Your Test Result Is Negative

A negative test result means the virus that causes COVID-19 was not found in your specimen, and you may have a lower risk of transmitting the disease to others. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19, though it does not rule out a COVID-19 infection.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Serial Testing (Repeat Testing)

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial self-testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19, or on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect the virus that causes COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-tests include instructions for performing serial testing, including the number of days between tests, and may include more than one test in the package.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer's instructions for use for serial testing, if applicable, that are included in the test box, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#)  or [antigen](#) ) on the FDA website. They may recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If you think your negative test result may be incorrect, contact a healthcare provider to determine whether or not additional testing is necessary.

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes invalid results or an error can show on the test device. Invalid results or an error can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the test may have malfunctioned.

Invalid test results are rare but can occur. If the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

CS-311760-C 04/13/2021

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [372 KB, 2 pages]

Español [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



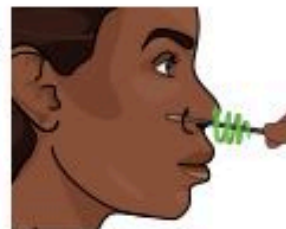
5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



[cdc.gov/coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

English [4 MB, 2 pages]

Español [4 MB, 2 pages]

USING YOUR HOME TEST KIT | COVID-19 |

1

Follow instructions very carefully.



2

Report your results on the app.



3

If your results are positive

Isolate yourself from others. As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

Tell your close contacts that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



4



Call your doctor with any questions, including whether a test result should be confirmed.



www.cdc.gov/covidtesting

Using Your COVID-19 Home Test Kit

English (B13 KB, 1 page)

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content



As of November 4, 2021

- Self-testing videos are now available to assist with how to use and interpret self-tests.
- Removed recommendation to report test results to healthcare providers or health departments.
- Added guidance about seeking assistance from a healthcare provider if the test result seems incorrect.

As of October 21, 2021

- Based on evolving evidence, CDC recommends fully vaccinated people get tested 5-7 days after close contact with a person with suspected or confirmed COVID-19.

As of August 2, 2021

- Added a recommendation for fully vaccinated people who have a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 to be tested 3–5 days after exposure, and to wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
- Added language about quarantining for fully vaccinated and unvaccinated people.

As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.

Last Updated Dec. 6, 2021



COVID-19

We have the tools to
Fight Omicron



Vaccines & Booster



Masks



Testing

Updated Dec. 29, 2021 [Languages](#) ▼

CDC has updated isolation and quarantine recommendations for the public. These recommendations do not apply to [healthcare personnel](#) and do not supersede state, local, tribal, or territorial laws, rules, and regulations. Read [CDC's media statement](#).

Summary of Recent Changes

Updates as of December 6, 2021 ^

- Added information on when and why to use a self-test. Self-testing is one of several risk-reduction strategies to reduce the chances of COVID-19 transmission. They may be used regardless of vaccination or symptom status.

[Previous updates](#)

Key Points

- COVID-19 self-tests (also referred to as home tests or over-the-counter (OTC) tests) are one of many risk-reduction measures, along with [vaccination](#), [masking](#), and physical distancing, that [protect you and others](#) by reducing the chances of spreading SARS-CoV-2, the virus that causes COVID-19.
- Self-tests can be taken at home or anywhere, are easy to use, and produce rapid results.
- You can use self-tests, regardless of vaccination status, or whether or not you have symptoms.
- Follow all of the manufacturer's instructions for performing the test.
- [If you test positive](#), you should [isolate](#) and inform your healthcare provider, as well as any [close contacts](#).
- Consider using a self-test before joining indoor gatherings with others who are not in your household.
- A positive self-test result means that the test detected the virus, and you are very likely to have an infection and should stay home or isolate for 10 days, wear a mask if you could have contact with others, and avoid indoor gatherings to reduce the risk of spreading disease to someone else.
- A negative self-test result means that the test did not detect the virus and you may not have an infection, but it does not rule out infection. Repeating the test within a few days, with at least 24 hours between tests, will increase the confidence that you are not infected.

[Overview](#)

[When to Consider Self-Testing](#)

[How to Use a Self-Test](#)

[If Your Test Is Positive](#)

[If Your Test Is Negative](#)

[Serial Testing \(Repeat Testing\)](#)

[If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error](#)

[Additional Print Resources](#)

Overview

Note: If your COVID-19 test is positive, tell a healthcare provider about your positive result and stay in contact with them during your illness. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow CDC's [guidance for isolation](#). Tell your [close contacts](#) that they have been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19.

Testing is critically important to help reduce the spread of the virus that causes COVID-19. If you have symptoms or had a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19, you should be tested, regardless of your vaccination status. You may also consider self-testing to screen for COVID-19 immediately before an activity to see if you are positive for COVID-19. You should [isolate](#) if you test positive.

If you need to be tested for COVID-19, consider using a **self-test** that can be performed at home or anywhere else. Sometimes a self-test is also called a “home test”, an “at-home test”, or an “over-the-counter (OTC) test.” Visit [FDA's website](#) [↗](#) for a list of authorized tests. Some self-tests may have age limitations.

Self-testing offers fast results. Self-tests are one of several options for testing for the virus that causes COVID-19 and may be more convenient than laboratory-based tests and point-of-care tests. Consider keeping self-tests at home or where you may need them.

Self-tests can also be used as one of many risk-reduction measures, along with vaccination, masking, and physical distancing, that [protect you and others](#) by reducing the chance of viral transmission. You can self-test, even if you don't have symptoms or are fully vaccinated, in order to make decisions that will help prevent spreading COVID-19 to others.

Self-tests can be purchased online or in pharmacies and retail stores. They are also available for free through some [local health departments](#) [↗](#) or Federally Qualified Health Centers (FQHC). As of November 2021, self-tests are available to detect [current infection](#). Self-tests are not available to detect antibodies to the virus that causes COVID-19.

When to Consider Self-Testing

Self-tests may be used if you have COVID-19 symptoms or have been exposed or potentially exposed to an individual with COVID-19.

Even if you don't have symptoms and have not been exposed to an individual with COVID-19, using a self-test before gathering indoors with others can give you information about the risk of spreading the virus that causes COVID-19. This is especially important before gathering with [unvaccinated children](#), [older individuals](#), those who are [immunocompromised](#), or [individuals at risk of severe disease](#).

A positive test result indicates that you likely have a current infection, and you should [isolate](#) and inform [close contacts](#).

A negative test result indicates that you may not be infected and may be at low risk of spreading disease to others, though it does not rule out an infection. Repeating the test will increase the confidence that you are not infected. Performing serial tests, meaning two or more tests over several days with at least 24 hours between tests—with one test as close as possible to the event you will attend—improves the reliability of testing and reduces your risk of transmitting disease to others even further. Some self-tests require this type of repeat testing in the manufacturer's instructions.



COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool

A tool to help you understand COVID-19 testing options.

Get Started

[About the Tool](#)

How to Use a Self-Test

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions for use before using the test. Talk to a healthcare provider if you have questions about the test or your results. Refer to CDC's videos on [How to Use a Self-Test](#) and [How to Interpret Self-Test Results](#).

Prepare to Collect a Specimen

- Wash your hands with soap and water for at least 20 seconds.
- Open the box and follow the instructions included with the self-test to collect your own nasal or saliva specimen.
- If you don't collect the specimens as directed, your test results may be incorrect.

Perform the Test

Follow the instructions exactly and perform the steps in the order that they are listed. The manufacturer may also provide other resources, such as quick reference guides or instructional videos, to help you perform the test correctly.

Most self-tests require the collection of a **nasal specimen** (see the [Additional Print Resources](#) section below). A few self-tests require a **saliva specimen**.

Once collected, use the specimen as described in the instructions to complete the self-test.

 Watch Video: [How to use a self test \[00:01:39\]](#)

Tips

- Store all test components according to the manufacturer's instructions until ready for use.
- Check the expiration date. Do not use expired tests or test components that are damaged or appear discolored based on the manufacturer's instructions.
- [Clean](#) the countertop, table, or other surfaces where you will do the test.
- Do not open test devices or other test components until you are ready to start the testing process.

- Have a timer ready because you may need to time several of the test steps.
- Read test results only within the amount of time specified in the manufacturer’s instructions. A result read before or after the specified timeframe may be incorrect.
- Don’t reuse test devices or other components.

After you have the results, discard the specimen collection swab or tube and test in the trash, [clean all surfaces](#) that the specimen may have touched, and wash your hands.

If Your Test Result Is Positive

You should stay home or isolate for 10 days and wear a mask if others could have contact with you. Also, tell a healthcare provider about your positive test result and stay in contact with them. If your illness becomes severe, seek medical attention. If you have an [emergency warning sign](#) (including trouble breathing), seek emergency medical care immediately. To avoid spreading the virus to others, follow [CDC recommendations](#).

Tell your [close contacts](#) that they may have been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19. A person with COVID-19 can begin spreading it starting 48 hours (or 2 days) before the person has any symptoms or tests positive. By informing your close contacts they may have been exposed, you are helping to protect everyone.

If you think your positive test result may be incorrect, contact a healthcare provider to determine whether or not additional testing is necessary.

 Watch Video: [How to interpret self test results \[00:01:32\]](#) 

If Your Test Result Is Negative

A negative test result means the virus that causes COVID-19 was not found in your specimen, and you may have a lower risk of transmitting the disease to others. If you took the test while you had symptoms and followed all instructions carefully, a negative result means your current illness is probably not COVID-19, though it does not rule out a COVID-19 infection.

However, it is possible for a test to give a negative result in some people who have COVID-19. This is called a false negative. You could also test negative if the specimen was collected too early in your infection. In this case, you could test positive later during your illness.

Serial Testing (Repeat Testing)

Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series. Serial self-testing is when a person tests themselves multiple times for COVID-19, or on a routine basis, such as every few days. By testing more frequently, you might detect the virus that causes COVID-19 more quickly and could reduce the spread of infection. Some self-tests include instructions for performing serial testing, including the number of days between tests, and may include more than one test in the package.

If your self-test is negative, you should follow the manufacturer’s instructions for use for serial testing, if applicable, that are included in the test box, or you can find the instructions for your test ([molecular](#)  or [antigen](#) ) on the FDA website. They may recommend you test again within 2 or 3 days. Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test results or serial testing. You may also use the [COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool](#) to help you determine the next steps after testing. If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), especially if you have been exposed to someone who has COVID-19, you should [quarantine according to CDC recommendations](#).

If you think your negative test result may be incorrect, contact a healthcare provider to determine whether or not additional testing is necessary.

If Your Result Shows Invalid or Error

Sometimes invalid results or an error can show on the test device. Invalid results or an error can occur for many reasons. Your specimen may not have been collected correctly, or the test may have malfunctioned.

Invalid test results are rare but can occur. If the self-test shows an invalid result or a test error, the test did not work properly. If this happens, refer to the instructions for use in the package insert and contact the manufacturer for assistance.

Additional Print Resources

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

[English](#)  [372 KB, 2 pages]
[Español](#)  [395 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

[English](#)  [4 MB, 2 pages]
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 [PDF - 1 page, 295 KB]

Using Your Self Test Kit

[English](#)  [295 KB, 1 page]

Previous Updates

Updates from Previous Content



As of November 4, 2021

- Self-testing videos are now available to assist with how to use and interpret self-tests.
- Removed recommendation to report test results to healthcare providers or health departments.
- Added guidance about seeking assistance from a healthcare provider if the test result seems incorrect.

As of October 21, 2021

- Based on evolving evidence, CDC recommends fully vaccinated people get tested 5-7 days after close contact with a person with suspected or confirmed COVID-19.

As of August 2, 2021

- Added a recommendation for fully vaccinated people who have a known exposure to someone with suspected or confirmed COVID-19 to be tested 3–5 days after exposure, and to wear a mask in public indoor settings for 14 days or until they receive a negative test result.
- Added language about quarantining for fully vaccinated and unvaccinated people.

As of July 21, 2021

- Added language about people with symptoms of COVID-19 being tested regardless of vaccination status.
- Expanded language on what to do if your self-test result is negative.
- Included a link to the new COVID-19 Viral Testing Tool.



Last Updated Dec. 29, 2021

 Your Health

About COVID-19	+
Variants of the Virus	+
Symptoms	+
Testing	+
Prevent Getting Sick	+
If You Are Sick	+
Specific Groups of People	+
Activities, Gatherings & Holidays	+
Travel	+
Archive	



Get Email Updates

To receive email updates about COVID-19, enter your email address:

Email Address

[What's this?](#)

Submit

CONTACT CDC



ABOUT CDC



POLICIES





U.S. Department of Health & Human Services

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LANGUAGE ASSISTANCE

Español

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한국어

Français

Polski

Português

Italiano

Tagalog

Русский

العربية

Kreyòl Ayisyen

Deutsch

日本語

فارسی

English



COVID-19

Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere

For doing rapid COVID-19 tests anywhere

Updated Feb. 16, 2022

What is a Self-Test or At-Home Test?

Self-tests for COVID-19 give rapid results and **can be taken anywhere**, regardless of your vaccination status or whether or not you have symptoms.

- They detect **current** infection and are sometimes also called “home tests,” “at-home tests,” or “over-the-counter (OTC) tests.”
- They give your **result in a few minutes** and are different from laboratory-based tests that may take days to return your result.
- Self-tests along with [vaccination](#), [wearing a well-fitted mask](#), and physical distancing, help [protect you and others](#) by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.
- Self-tests **do not** detect antibodies which would suggest a previous infection and they do not measure your level of immunity.

When to Consider Taking an At-Home COVID-19 Test

If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), test yourself immediately.

If you were exposed to someone with COVID-19, test yourself at least 5 days after your exposure. If you test negative for COVID-19, consider testing again 1 to 2 days after your first test.

If you are going to an indoor event or a gathering, test yourself immediately before or as close to the time of the event as possible. This is especially important before gathering with [individuals at risk of severe disease](#), [older adults](#), those who are [immunocompromised](#), or people who are not [up to date on their COVID-19 vaccines](#), including children who cannot get vaccinated yet.

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- If you're not able to obtain a self-test when you need it, you might also **visit a community testing site, or call your local health department** for more options.

Go to COVIDtests.gov

FDA-Authorized Tests

How to Use an At-Home COVID-19 Test

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions for use before using the test.

- To use an at-home test, you will collect a nasal specimen and then test that specimen.
- If you do not follow the manufacturer's instructions, your test result may be incorrect.
- Wash your hands before and after you collect a nasal specimen for your test.

 Watch Video: [How to use a self-test \[00:01:32\]](#)

Need More Information? Find [videos of manufacturer instructions](#) for your specific self-test.

What Your Test Results Mean

IF YOUR TEST IS

Positive

- The test detected the virus and **you have an infection.**
- Stay home for at least 5 days and [isolate](#) from others in your home.
- Tell your [close contacts](#).
- Wear a [well-fitted mask](#) when around others. If available, a N95 or KN95 respirator is recommended.
- Watch for [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Tell your healthcare provider. Contact them as soon as possible if:
 - Your symptoms get worse.
 - You are more likely to get very sick because you are an [older adult](#) or have an [underlying medical condition](#). [Possible treatment](#) may be available for you.
 - You have questions about your isolation.

IF YOUR TEST IS

Negative

- The test did not detect the virus, **but doesn't rule out an infection.**
- Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series (also known as serial testing). Consider repeating the test 24 to 48 hours later. Multiple negative tests increases the confidence that you are not infected with the virus that causes COVID-19.

If you think your test result may be incorrect, contact the test manufacturer for assistance, consider taking another at-home test, or contact a healthcare provider for help.

 **Watch Video:** [How to interpret self-test results \[00:02:45\]](#)

 **Watch Video:** [How to interpret self-test positive results - ASL \[00:02:37\]](#)

Related Questions

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If you have difficulty accessing the internet or need additional support placing an order, you can call [1-800-232-0233](tel:1-800-232-0233) (TTY [1-888-720-7489](tel:1-888-720-7489)) 8am to midnight ET, 7 days a week. Help is available in English, Spanish, and more than 150 other languages.

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For a list of authorized self-tests, see [FDA EUA Tests](#) . Some tests may have age limitations for self-collection or collection by an adult for a child.

Should I trust the results of a self-test?

Positive results from self-tests are highly reliable.

Negative results from self-tests do not rule out SARS-CoV-2 infection. A negative self-test result may not be reliable, especially if you have symptoms associated with COVID-19.

Invalid results from self-tests mean the test did not work properly, and a new test is needed to get an accurate result.

Do I need to report the results from my self-test?

CDC strongly encourages everyone who uses a self-test to report any positive results to their healthcare provider. Healthcare providers can ensure that those who have tested positive for COVID-19 receive the most appropriate medical care, including specific treatments if necessary.

In most jurisdictions, healthcare providers who diagnose COVID-19 are required to report those cases to public health.

The US Government does not want to construct any barriers that would deter the use of self-tests. COVID-19 surveillance continues to be based on results from laboratory testing. The primary role of case reporting is to allow public health agencies to take actions to mitigate disease spread. The public health community, including CDC, is confident that situational awareness remains strong without receiving self-test results.

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch (1.5 cm)** into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



PRINTOUT

Don't Delay: Test Soon and Treat Early

- English [262 KB, 1 page]
- Spanish [262 KB, 1 page]

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PRINTOUT

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

- English [372 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



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PRINTOUT

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

- English 📄 [4 MB, 2 pages]
- Spanish 📄 [4 MB, 2 pages]

Additional Print Resources

Helpful Links

[COVIDtests.gov](https://www.covidtests.gov) 📄

[FDA-Authorized At-Home Tests](#) 📄

[Symptoms of COVID-19](#)

[Underlying Medical Conditions](#)

[Talking to Close Contacts](#)

[Quarantine and Isolation](#)

Last Updated Feb. 16, 2022

The Wayback Machine - <https://web.archive.org/web/20220401003807/https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/self-...>



COVID-19

Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere

For doing rapid COVID-19 tests anywhere

Updated Mar. 9, 2022

What is a Self-Test or At-Home Test?

Self-tests for COVID-19 give rapid results and **can be taken anywhere**, regardless of your vaccination status or whether or not you have symptoms.

- They detect **current** infection and are sometimes also called “home tests,” “at-home tests,” or “over-the-counter (OTC) tests.”
- They give your **result in a few minutes** and are different from laboratory-based tests that may take days to return your result.
- Self-tests along with [vaccination](#), [wearing a well-fitted mask](#), and physical distancing, help [protect you and others](#) by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.
- Self-tests **do not** detect antibodies which would suggest a previous infection and they do not measure your level of immunity.

When to Consider Taking an At-Home COVID-19 Test

If you have [COVID-19 symptoms](#), test yourself immediately.

If you were exposed to someone with COVID-19, test yourself at least 5 days after your exposure. If you test negative for COVID-19, consider testing again 1 to 2 days after your first test.

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» Learn what to do if you [test positive](#) or [test negative](#).

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FDA-Authorized Tests

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 Watch Video: [How to use a self-test – ASL \[00:03:25\]](#)

Need More Information? Find [videos of manufacturer instructions](#) for your specific self-test.

What Your Test Results Mean

IF YOUR TEST IS Positive

- The test detected the virus and **you have an infection.**
- Stay home for at least 5 days and [isolate](#) from others in your home.
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- Wear a [well-fitted mask](#) when around others. If available, a N95 or KN95 respirator is recommended.
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- The test did not detect the virus, **but doesn’t rule out an infection.**
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Related Questions

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Print Resources

DON'T DELAY: TEST SOON AND TREAT EARLY

| COVID-19 |

If you are at high risk of getting very sick from COVID-19, and test positive, treatment may be available.





POSITIVE

Get tested as soon as possible after your symptoms start.

Contact your healthcare provider right away if your result is positive.





Don't delay. Treatment must be started early to work.



cdc.gov/coronavirus

COVID-19 | February 6, 2022 10:26 AM

- PRINTOUT
- Don't Delay: Test Soon and Treat Early
- English  [262 KB, 1 page]
 - Additional Languages

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https://web.archive.org/web/20220401003807/https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus/2019-ncov/testing/self-testing.html

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6/7



Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere

For doing rapid COVID-19 tests anywhere

Updated Mar. 9, 2022

CDC is reviewing this page to align with updated guidance.

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- Tell your healthcare provider. Contact them as soon as possible if:
 - Your symptoms get worse.
 - You are more likely to get very sick because you are an [older adult](#) or have an [underlying medical condition](#). [Possible treatment](#) may be available for you.
 - You have questions about your isolation.

IF YOUR TEST IS

Negative

- The test did not detect the virus, **but doesn't rule out an infection**.
- Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series (also known as serial testing). Consider repeating the test 24 to 48 hours later. Multiple negative tests increases the confidence that you are not infected with the virus that causes COVID-19.

If you think your test result may be incorrect, contact the test manufacturer for assistance, consider taking another at-home test, or contact a healthcare provider for help.

▶ **Watch Video:** [How To Interpret Self-Test Results \[00:04:15\]](#) | [Español \[00:05:17\]](#)

▶ **Watch Video:** [How To Interpret Self-Test Positive Results - ASL \[00:02:37\]](#)

▶ **Watch Video:** [How To Interpret Self-Test Negative Results - ASL \[00:03:00\]](#)

Need additional help? [CDC's Viral Testing Tool](#) is an online, mobile-friendly tool that asks a series of questions, and provides recommended actions and resources based on a user's responses.

Related Questions

[How can I get a free COVID-19 test?](#)

Self-tests can be ordered online at [COVIDtests.gov](#). Placing an order only requires your name and residential address. You may also share your email address to get updates on your order. No ID, credit card, or health insurance information is required.

If you have difficulty accessing the internet or need additional support placing an order, you can call [1-800-232-0233](#) (TTY [1-888-720-7489](#)) 8am to midnight ET, 7 days a week. Help is available in English, Spanish, and more than 150 other languages.

The [Disability Information and Access Line](#) (DIAL) is also available to specifically help people with disabilities place their orders. To get help, call [1-888-677-1199](#), Monday-Friday from 9AM to 8PM ET, or email DIAL@usaginganddisability.org

For those who have questions about eligibility to receive free tests, the online ordering form, shipping, or delivery, you can contact the USPS Help Desk at 1-800-ASK-USPS ([1-800-275-8777](#)).

Self-tests can also be purchased online or in pharmacies and retail stores and may be reimbursed through your health insurance. They are also available at no cost through some [local health departments](#) and Community Health Centers.

For a list of authorized self-tests, see [FDA EUA Tests](#). Some tests may have age limitations for self-collection or collection by an adult for a child.

[Should I trust the results of a self-test?](#)

Positive results from self-tests are highly reliable.

Negative results from self-tests do not rule out SARS-CoV-2 infection. A negative self-test result may not be reliable, especially if you have symptoms associated with COVID-19.

Invalid results from self-tests mean the test did not work properly, and a new test is needed to get an accurate result.

[Do I need to report the results from my self-test?](#)

CDC strongly encourages everyone who uses a self-test to report any positive results to their healthcare provider. Healthcare providers can ensure that those who have tested positive for COVID-19 receive the most appropriate medical care, including specific treatments if necessary.

In most jurisdictions, healthcare providers who diagnose COVID-19 are required to report those cases to public health.

The US Government does not want to construct any barriers that would deter the use of self-tests. COVID-19 surveillance continues to be based on results from laboratory testing. The primary role of case reporting is to allow public health agencies to take actions to mitigate disease spread. The public health community, including CDC, is confident that situational awareness remains strong without receiving self-test results.

Print Resources



How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit, i.e., instructions before starting specimen collection.

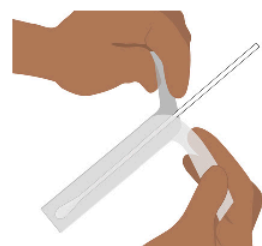


2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.

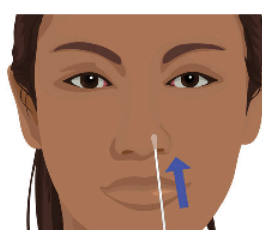


Specimen collection

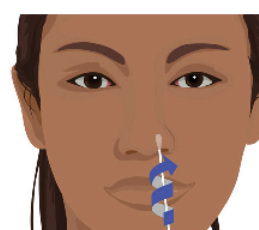
3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



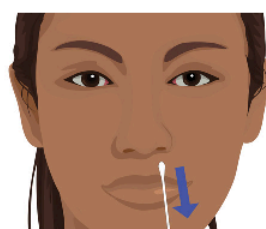
4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.



CS317702-C 04/13/2021

cdc.gov/coronavirus

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

[PDF - 372 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.

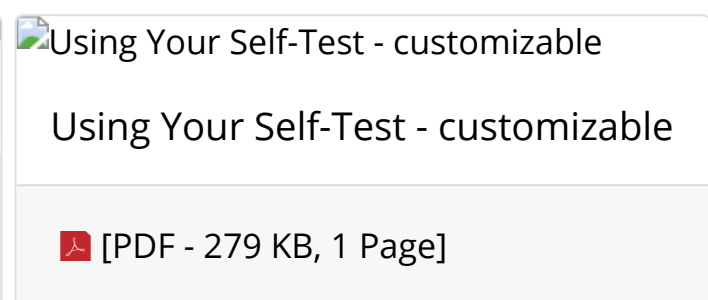


5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

[PDF - 4 MB, 2 pages]



Helpful Links

COVIDtests.gov 

FDA-Authorized At-Home Tests

Symptoms of COVID-19

Underlying Medical Conditions

Talking to Close Contacts

Quarantine and Isolation

Additional Print Resources

Helpful Links

[COVIDtests.gov](#) 

[FDA-Authorized At-Home Tests](#) 

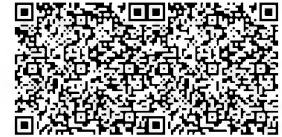
[Symptoms of COVID-19](#)

[Underlying Medical Conditions](#)

[Talking to Close Contacts](#)

[Quarantine and Isolation](#)

Last Updated Mar. 9, 2022



Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere

For doing rapid COVID-19 tests anywhere

Updated Sept. 6, 2022

CDC is reviewing this page to align with updated guidance.

What is a Self-Test or At-Home Test?

Self-tests for COVID-19 give rapid results and **can be taken anywhere**, regardless of your vaccination status or whether or not you have symptoms.

- They detect **current** infection and are sometimes also called “home tests,” “at-home tests,” or “over-the-counter (OTC) tests.”
- They give your **result in a few minutes** and are different from laboratory-based tests that may take days to return your result.
- Self-tests along with **vaccination**, **wearing a well-fitted mask**, and physical distancing, help **protect you and others** by reducing the chances of spreading COVID-19.
- Self-tests **do not** detect antibodies which would suggest a previous infection and they do not measure your level of immunity.

When to Consider Taking an At-Home COVID-19 Test

If you have **COVID-19 symptoms**, test yourself immediately.

If you were exposed to someone with COVID-19, test yourself at least 5 days after your exposure. If you test negative for COVID-19, consider testing again 1 to 2 days after your first test.

If you are going to an indoor event or a gathering, test yourself immediately before or as close to the time of the event as possible. This is especially important before gathering with **individuals at risk of severe disease**, **older adults**,

those who are [immunocompromised](#), or people who are not [up to date on their COVID-19 vaccines](#), including children who cannot get vaccinated yet.

» Learn what to do if you [test positive](#) or [test negative](#).

How to Get an At-Home COVID-19 Test

- **Buy tests** online or in pharmacies and retail stores. Private health insurance may reimburse the cost of purchasing self-tests. Visit [FDA's website](#) [🔗](#) for a list of authorized tests.
- Free tests may also be available through local health departments.
- If you're not able to obtain a self-test when you need it, you might also **visit a community testing site, or call your local health department** for more options.

[FDA-Authorized Tests](#)

How to Use an At-Home COVID-19 Test

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions for use before using the test.

- To use an at-home test, you will collect a nasal specimen and then test that specimen.
- If you do not follow the manufacturer's instructions, your test result may be incorrect.
- Wash your hands before and after you collect a nasal specimen for your test.

[▶ Watch Video: How To Use a Self-Test \[00:03:08\]](#) | [Español \[00:04:02\]](#)

[▶ Watch Video: How To Use a Self-Test – ASL \[00:03:25\]](#)

Need More Information? Find [videos of manufacturer instructions](#) for your specific self-test.

What Your Test Results Mean

IF YOUR TEST IS

Positive

- The test detected the virus and **you have an infection**.
- Stay home for at least 5 days and **isolate** from others in your home.
- Tell your **close contacts**.
- Wear a **well-fitted mask** when around others. If available, a N95 or KN95 respirator is recommended.
- Watch for **symptoms**. If you have any **emergency warning signs**, seek emergency care immediately.
- Tell your healthcare provider. Contact them as soon as possible if:
 - Your symptoms get worse.
 - You are more likely to get very sick because you are an **older adult** or have an **underlying medical condition**. **Possible treatment** may be available for you.
 - You have questions about your isolation.

IF YOUR TEST IS

Negative

- The test did not detect the virus, **but doesn't rule out an infection**.
- Some self-tests are designed to be used in a series (also known as serial testing). Consider repeating the test 24 to 48 hours later. Multiple negative tests increases the confidence that you are not infected with the virus that causes COVID-19.

If you think your test result may be incorrect, contact the test manufacturer for assistance, consider taking another at-home test, or contact a healthcare provider for help.

▶ **Watch Video:** [How To Interpret Self-Test Results \[00:04:15\]](#) | [Español \[00:05:17\]](#)

▶ **Watch Video:** [How To Interpret Self-Test Positive Results - ASL \[00:02:37\]](#)

▶ **Watch Video:** [How To Interpret Self-Test Negative Results - ASL \[00:03:00\]](#)

Need additional help? [CDC's Viral Testing Tool](#) is an online, mobile-friendly tool that asks a series of questions, and provides recommended actions and resources based on a user's responses.

Related Questions

Should I trust the results of a self-test?



Positive results from self-tests are highly reliable.

Negative results from self-tests do not rule out SARS-CoV-2 infection. A negative self-test result may not be reliable, especially if you have symptoms associated with COVID-19.

Invalid results from self-tests mean the test did not work properly, and a new test is needed to get an accurate result.

Do I need to report the results from my self-test?



CDC strongly encourages everyone who uses a self-test to report any positive results to their healthcare provider. Healthcare providers can ensure that those who have tested positive for COVID-19 receive the most appropriate medical care, including specific treatments if necessary.

In most jurisdictions, healthcare providers who diagnose COVID-19 are required to report those cases to public health.

The US Government does not want to construct any barriers that would deter the use of self-tests. COVID-19 surveillance continues to be based on results from laboratory testing. The primary role of case reporting is to allow public health agencies to take actions to mitigate disease spread. The public health community, including CDC, is confident that situational awareness remains strong without receiving self-test results.

Print Resources

DON'T DELAY: TEST SOON AND TREAT EARLY

| COVID-19 |

If you are at high risk of getting very sick from COVID-19, and test positive, treatment may be available.



Get tested as soon as possible after your symptoms start.

Contact your healthcare provider right away if your result is positive.



Don't delay. Treatment must be started early to work.



cdc.gov/coronavirus

Don't Delay: Test Soon and Treat Early

[PDF - 361 KB, 1 page]

How to Collect an Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit given to you by your healthcare provider or personnel at the testing center, or purchased over the counter in a pharmacy or other store. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit which may be used on-site or at home. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen, unless the kit says to do otherwise. These instructions can also be used with self-testing kits if the kit specifies anterior nasal swab collection.

Set-up

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit, i. instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab into your nostril **no more than 3/4 of an inch** (1.5 cm) into your nose.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently pressing against the inside of your nostril at least 4 times for a total of 15 seconds. Get as much nasal discharge as possible on the soft end of the swab.



6. Gently remove the swab.



7. Using the same swab, repeat steps 4–6 in your other nostril with the same end of the swab.

(S317702-C 04/13/2021)

c [c.c.gov coronavirus](https://www.cdc.gov/coronavirus)

How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

 [PDF - 372 KB, 2 pages]

How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Specimen for COVID-19 Testing



Use **only** an authorized specimen collection kit. Get a kit from your healthcare provider or a testing center. Kits are available at a pharmacy or other retail outlet. Follow the instructions included with the specimen collection kit. Use **only** materials provided in the kit to collect and store or mail the specimen unless the kit says to do otherwise. Use these instructions with kits that specify a nasal mid-turbinate swab collection.

Setup

1. Disinfect the surface where you will open the collection kit. Remove and lay out contents of kit. Read instructions before starting specimen collection.



2. Wash hands with soap and water. If soap and water are not available, use hand sanitizer.



Specimen Collection

3. Remove the swab from the package. Do not touch the soft end with your hands or anything else.



4. Insert the entire soft end of the swab straight back into your nostril **less than one inch** (about 2cm) or until you feel resistance.



5. Slowly rotate the swab, gently rubbing it along the insides of your nasal passage several times.



How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing

 [PDF - 4 MB, 2 pages]

USING YOUR SELF-TEST | COVID-19 |

1

Follow instructions very carefully.



2

Use the QR code below for more information about self-testing and how-to videos.



3

If your results are positive

Isolate yourself from others. As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

Tell your close contacts that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



4



If you are at an increased risk of becoming very sick, treatment maybe be available. Contact your health care provider right away if your test result is positive.



www.cdc.gov/covidtesting

Using Your Self-Test

 [PDF - 295 KB, 1 page]



USING YOUR SELF-TEST | COVID-19 |

1

Follow instructions very carefully.



2

Use the QR code below for more information about self-testing and how-to videos.



3

If your results are positive

Isolate yourself from others. As much as possible, stay in a specific room and away from other people and pets in your home.

Tell your close contacts that they may have been exposed to COVID-19.



4



If you are at an increased risk of becoming severely ill, treatment may be available. Contact your health care provider right away if your test result is positive.

Name of provider

Phone number of provider



www.cdc.gov/covidtesting



COVID-19

Using Your Self-Test - customizable

 [PDF - 279 KB, 1 Page]

1/5

Helpful Links

[FDA-Authorized At-Home Tests](#) 

[Symptoms of COVID-19](#)

[Underlying Medical Conditions](#)

[Talking to Close Contacts](#)

[Quarantine and Isolation](#)

Last Updated Sept. 6, 2022



Error processing SSI file

Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere

For doing rapid COVID-19 tests anywhere

Updated Apr. 25, 2023

What is a Self-Test or At-Home Test?

Self-tests for COVID-19 give rapid results and **can be taken anywhere**.

- Self-tests detect **current** infection and are sometimes also called “home tests,” “at-home tests,” or “over-the-counter (OTC) tests.”
- They give you **results in 10-15 minutes** and are usually antigen tests. These are different from laboratory-based PCR tests or self-collected samples that are sent to a laboratory; these may take days to return your result.
- Although self-tests are usually faster, they are not as good at detecting the virus as PCR tests, meaning you might get a false negative result.
 - FDA recommends people who get an initial negative result on an antigen test, take at least one more test 48 hours later. Take a third test, 48 hours after the second, if the second test was negative and you don't have symptoms. Self-tests are more likely to detect the virus if you have symptoms.
 - You may get a [PCR test](#) as an alternative to repeat testing.
- Self-tests, along with [vaccination](#) and [prevention actions](#), can help you protect yourself and others.

When To Take an At-Home COVID-19 Test

Test Yourself If...

You have any [COVID-19 symptoms](#)

Timing

Test Immediately.

If you **test negative** for COVID-19 using an at-home antigen test, **repeat*** the test again 48 hours after your first test. Also, consider consulting a healthcare provider to see if you need to be tested for another viral infection or illness. Follow precautions on how to protect yourself and others.

Test Yourself If...

You were exposed to someone with COVID-19

Timing

Test at least 5 full days after your exposure.

If you **test negative** for COVID-19 using an at-home antigen test, **repeat*** the test again 48 hours after your first test. If both tests are negative, then repeat testing after another 48 hours for a total of three tests.

*You may get a **PCR test** as an alternative to repeat testing.

Testing can be helpful even when you don't have symptoms or a recent exposure to COVID-19, such as before an event or visiting someone. Test as close to the time of the event as possible (at least within 1-2 days) to help you make informed decisions about your health and your risk of spreading COVID-19 to others.

» Learn what to do if you **test positive** or **test negative**.

 **Watch Video: When To Use a Self-Test [00:03:36]**

How to Get an At-Home COVID-19 Test

- **Buy tests** online or in pharmacies and retail stores. Private health insurance may reimburse the cost of purchasing self-tests. Visit [FDA's website](#)  for a list of authorized tests.
- **Contact** your local health department to find out about the availability of free tests.
- If you're not able to obtain a self-test when you need it, you might also visit a **community testing site** , or **contact a healthcare provider** for more options.

How to Use an At-Home COVID-19 Test

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions for use before using the test.

- Wash your hands before and after you collect a nasal specimen for your test.
- To use an at-home test, you will collect a nasal specimen and then test that specimen.
- If you do not follow the manufacturer's instructions, your test result may be incorrect.
- The manufacturer may have extended the expiration date for your self-test. Please check the manufacturer's website to confirm the expiration date, if needed.

 **Watch Video:** [How To Use a Self-Test \[00:02:03\]](#)



What Your Test Results Mean

If Your Test Is

Positive

A positive COVID-19 test means the virus was detected and **you have an infection.**

- **Isolate** and take precautions, including wearing a [high-quality mask](#) to protect others from getting infected.
- Tell people you had recent contact with that they [may have been exposed](#).
- Monitor your [symptoms](#). If you have any [emergency warning signs](#), seek emergency care immediately.
- Contact a healthcare provider, [community health center](#) , or pharmacy to learn about [treatment options](#) that may be available to you. Treatment must be started within several days after you first develop symptoms to be effective.
 - You are more likely to get very sick if you are an older adult or have an underlying medical condition. [Treatment](#) is available. Talk with your healthcare provider to determine what is the best option for you.

 **Watch Video:** [What to Do If Your Self-Test Result Is Positive \[00:02:30\]](#)

If Your Test Is

Negative

A negative COVID-19 test means the test did not detect the virus, but this **doesn't rule out that you could have an infection.** See [FDA instructions on repeat testing](#) .

- If you have [symptoms](#):
 - You may have COVID-19, but tested before the virus was detectable.

- You may have another viral infection or illness that you need to get tested for. For many diseases, including [flu](#), early diagnosis and prompt treatment is important for preventing severe illness.
- Take [everyday preventive actions](#) to prevent spreading an illness to others.
- Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result or if your symptoms worsen.
- If you do not have symptoms, but were exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you should continue to take [recommended steps after exposure](#).
- If you do not have symptoms and have not been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, continue to take steps to [protect yourself and others](#), including monitoring for symptoms. Get tested again if symptoms appear.

☐ **Watch Video:** [What to Do If Your Self-Test Result Is Negative](#) [00:02:41]

- › **Incorrect result?** If you think your test result may be incorrect, contact the test manufacturer for assistance, consider taking another at-home test, or contact a healthcare provider for help.
- › **Safely report results:** COVID-19 home tests can be safely and privately reported at [MakeMyTestCount.org](#) ☐.
- › **Need additional help with COVID-19 testing?** [WhenToTest.org](#) ☐ is an online, mobile-friendly tool that helps you make decisions about COVID-19 testing.

Related Questions

[Should I trust the results of a self-test?](#)



Positive results from self-tests are highly reliable.

Negative results from self-tests don't rule out that you could have an infection. See [FDA instructions on repeat testing](#) ☐.

Invalid results from self-tests mean the test did not work properly, and you need to take a new test to get an accurate result.

[Do I need to report the results from my self-test?](#)



CDC strongly encourages everyone who uses a self-test to report any positive results to their healthcare provider. COVID-19 home tests can be safely and privately reported at [MakeMyTestCount.org](https://www.mymedicaltestcount.org) . Healthcare providers can ensure that those who have tested positive for COVID-19 receive the most appropriate medical care, including specific treatments if necessary.

In certain jurisdictions, healthcare providers who diagnose COVID-19 are required to report those cases to public health.

Resources

Print Resources

[How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing](#)  [423KB, 2 pages]

[How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing](#)  [3.5MB, 2 pages]

[Using Your Self-Test](#)  [276KB, 1 page]

[Using Your Self-Test – customizable](#)  [279KB, 1 page]

[Don't Delay: Test Soon and Treat Early](#)  [262KB, 1 page]

Related Pages

- › [FDA-Authorized At-Home Tests](#) 
- › [Symptoms of COVID-19](#)
- › [Underlying Medical Conditions](#)
- › [What to Do If You Were Exposed to COVID-19](#)
- › [Isolation](#)

Last Updated Apr. 25, 2023



COVID-19 Home

Self-Testing At Home or Anywhere

For doing rapid COVID-19 tests anywhere

Updated Sept. 25, 2023

Free COVID-19 Tests

Visit COVIDTests.gov to order 4 additional free FDA-authorized COVID-19 tests.

Every home in the U.S. is eligible to order 4 free at-home tests beginning November 20, 2023. If you did not order 4 tests earlier in the fall, you can place two orders for a total of 8 tests.

What is a Self-Test or At-Home Test?

Self-tests for COVID-19 give rapid results and **can be taken anywhere**.

- Self-tests detect **current** infection and are sometimes also called "home tests," "at-home tests," or "over-the-counter (OTC) tests."
- They give you **results in 10-15 minutes** and are usually antigen tests. These are different from laboratory-based PCR tests or self-collected samples that are sent to a laboratory; these may take days to return your result.
- Although self-tests are usually faster, they are not as good at detecting the virus as PCR tests, meaning you might get a false negative result.
 - FDA recommends people who get an initial negative result on an antigen test, take at least one more test 48 hours later. Take a third test, 48 hours after the second, if the second test was negative and you don't have

symptoms. Self-tests are more likely to detect the virus if you have symptoms.

- You may get a [PCR test](#) as an alternative to repeat testing.
- Self-tests, along with [vaccination](#) and [prevention actions](#), can help you protect yourself and others.

When To Take an At-Home COVID-19 Test

Test Yourself If...

You have any [COVID-19 symptoms](#)

Timing

Test Immediately.

If you **test negative** for COVID-19 using an at-home antigen test, [repeat](#)* the test again 48 hours after your first test. Also, consider consulting a healthcare provider to see if you need to be tested for another viral infection or illness. Follow precautions on how to protect yourself and others.

Test Yourself If...

You were exposed to someone with COVID-19

Timing

Test at least 5 full days after your exposure.

If you **test negative** for COVID-19 using an at-home antigen test, [repeat](#)* the test again 48 hours after your first test. If both tests are negative, then repeat testing after another 48 hours for a total of three tests.

*You may get a [PCR test](#) as an alternative to repeat testing.

Testing can be helpful even when you don't have symptoms or a recent exposure to COVID-19, such as before an event or visiting someone. Test as close to the time of the event as possible (at least within 1-2 days) to help you make informed decisions about your health and your risk of spreading COVID-19 to others.

» Learn what to do if you [test positive](#) or [test negative](#).

 **Watch Video:** [When To Use a Self-Test \[00:03:36\]](#)

How to Get an At-Home COVID-19 Test

- Order Four (4) free at-home COVID-19 tests available for U.S. households through the federal government at [COVID.gov/tests](https://www.covid.gov/tests) .
- **Buy tests** online or in pharmacies and retail stores. Private health insurance may reimburse the cost of purchasing self-tests. Visit [FDA's website](#)  for a list of authorized tests.
- **Contact** your local health department to find out about the availability of free tests.
- If you're not able to obtain a self-test when you need it, you might also **visit a community testing site** , or **contact a healthcare provider** for more options.

How to Use an At-Home COVID-19 Test

Read the complete manufacturer's instructions for use before using the test.

- Wash your hands before and after you collect a nasal specimen for your test.
- To use an at-home test, you will collect a nasal specimen and then test that specimen.
- If you do not follow the manufacturer's instructions, your test result may be incorrect.
- The manufacturer may have extended the expiration date for your self-test. Please check the manufacturer's website to confirm the expiration date, if needed.

 **Watch Video:** [How To Use a Self-Test](#) [00:02:03]



What Your Test Results Mean

If Your Test Is

Positive

A positive COVID-19 test means the virus was detected and **you have an infection**.

- **Isolate** and take precautions, including wearing a **high-quality mask** to protect others from getting infected.
- Tell people you had recent contact with that they **may have been exposed**.
- Monitor your **symptoms**. If you have any **emergency warning signs**, seek emergency care immediately.
- Contact a healthcare provider, **community health center** [📍](#), or pharmacy to learn about **treatment options** that may be available to you. Treatment must be started within several days after you first develop symptoms to be effective.
 - You are more likely to get very sick if you are an older adult or have an underlying medical condition. **Treatment** is available. Talk with your healthcare provider to determine what is the best option for you.



Watch Video: [What to Do If Your Self-Test Result Is Positive](#) [00:02:30]

If Your Test Is

Negative

A negative COVID-19 test means the test did not detect the virus, but this **doesn't rule out that you could have an infection**. See [FDA instructions on repeat testing](#) [📄](#).

- If you have **symptoms**:
 - You may have COVID-19, but tested before the virus was detectable.
 - You may have another viral infection or illness that you need to get tested for. For many diseases, including **flu**, early diagnosis and prompt treatment is important for preventing severe illness.
 - Take **everyday preventive actions** to prevent spreading an illness to others.
 - Contact a healthcare provider if you have any questions about your test result or if your symptoms worsen.
- If you do not have symptoms, but were exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, you should continue to take **recommended steps after exposure**.
- If you do not have symptoms and have not been exposed to the virus that causes COVID-19, continue to take steps to **protect yourself and others**, including monitoring for symptoms. Get tested again if symptoms appear.

 **Watch Video:** [What to Do If Your Self-Test Result Is Negative](#) [00:02:41]

- › **Incorrect result?** If you think your test result may be incorrect, contact the test manufacturer for assistance, consider taking another at-home test, or contact a healthcare provider for help.
- › **Safely report results:** COVID-19 home tests can be safely and privately reported at [MakeMyTestCount.org](#) .
- › **Need additional help with COVID-19 testing?** [WhenToTest.org](#)  is an online, mobile-friendly tool that helps you make decisions about COVID-19 testing.

Related Questions

[Should I trust the results of a self-test?](#)



Positive results from self-tests are highly reliable.

Negative results from self-tests don't rule out that you could have an infection. See [FDA instructions on repeat testing](#) .

Invalid results from self-tests mean the test did not work properly, and you need to take a new test to get an accurate result.

[Do I need to report the results from my self-test?](#)



CDC strongly encourages everyone who uses a self-test to report any positive results to their healthcare provider. COVID-19 home tests can be safely and privately reported at [MakeMyTestCount.org](#) . Healthcare providers can ensure that those who have tested positive for COVID-19 receive the most appropriate medical care, including specific treatments if necessary.

In certain jurisdictions, healthcare providers who diagnose COVID-19 are required to report those cases to public health.

Resources

Print Resources



[How to Collect An Anterior Nasal Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing](#) ■ [423KB, 2 pages]

[How to Collect a Nasal Mid-Turbinate Swab Specimen for COVID-19 Testing](#) ■ [3.5MB, 2 pages]

[Using Your Self-Test](#) ■ [276KB, 1 page]

[Using Your Self-Test – customizable](#) ■ [279KB, 1 page]

[Don't Delay: Test Soon and Treat Early](#) ■ [262KB, 1 page]

Related Pages

- › [FDA-Authorized At-Home Tests](#) 
- › [Symptoms of COVID-19](#)
- › [Underlying Medical Conditions](#)
- › [What to Do If You Were Exposed to COVID-19](#)
- › [Isolation](#)

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